

FILING CHECKLIST

Follow these steps to file your Answer with the court. Check off each item as you complete it.

■ Step 1: Review Your Packet

Read through all documents. Make sure everything looks correct.

■ Step 2: Sign the Answer Form

Sign and date the Form 1.947(b) Answer where indicated.

■ Step 3: Make Copies

Make at least 3 copies of EVERY document in your packet.

■ Step 4: File with the Court Clerk

Take the original + 2 copies to the county courthouse where your case was filed. Ask the clerk to stamp all copies as 'Filed'.

■ Step 5: Pay Filing Fee (or Request Waiver)

There may be a filing fee. If you cannot afford it, ask the clerk for an 'Affidavit of Indigency' form.

■ Step 6: Serve the Landlord

You must deliver a copy of your filed Answer to the landlord or their attorney. Keep proof of delivery (certified mail receipt, hand-delivery receipt, or email confirmation).

■ Step 7: Deposit Rent into Court Registry

If you raised any defense other than 'I already paid,' you must deposit the rent into the court registry. Check with the clerk for the exact amount and process.

■ Step 8: Note Your Deadline

Your response deadline is shown on your summons. Count 5 business days (excluding weekends and holidays) from the date you were served.

■ Step 9: Prepare for Hearing

If a hearing is scheduled, bring all your documents, evidence, and a list of what you want to say to the judge.

■ Step 10: Attend All Court Dates

If you miss a court date, the judge may enter a default judgment against you.